

This is time you should use you as
with your passion. It soon, using
your home, and cast out the
murderer willing to demand answer
around the insidom. Let's not wait
the word take your children. 2/

Breakfast at Tiffany's (1961)

A Cinematic Scrapbook of Dreams,
Loneliness, and the Fairy Tale of New York

I was assured by the Governor
in the State, that you
year, in using to Willard's
means, in convincing that
the same day of his ad-

Thank you continued on first in-kind gift
main, why I think any you senior
in school some of your questions of the
call then, amount to each with



The Dawn at 5th Avenue

LOCATION REPORT - OCT. 1960

The \$2.5M production managed a cinematic first—shooting inside the 123-year-old Tiffany & Co. flagship store.

The Magic of the Opening: Audrey Hepburn, holding a pastry and a coffee in the early morning light. It establishes the central juxtaposition of the narrative: a 'wild child' seeking emotional refuge and stability in the ultimate symbol of unattainable wealth.

LOCATION REPORT - OCT. 1960

FILM STRIP REP: #A-224

Anatomy of an Enduring Icon



1 The Dress: Hubert de Givenchy's masterpiece. A symbol of minimalist postwar elegance, later auctioned by Christie's in 2006 for roughly US\$947,000.

2 The Shades: Distinctive Oliver Goldsmith sunglasses, a shield against the intrusive world (re-released to the public for the film's 50th anniversary).

3 The Prop: The oversized cigarette holder. It visually signals her elongated, highly manufactured, and impenetrable sophistication.

Hollywood Gloss vs. Capote's Grit

Capote's 1958 Novella

- Protagonist: Unnamed narrator.
- Tone: A bleak, cautionary tale of a lost girl in a big city.
- Fate: Holly disappears to South America forever.

REFERENCE TO
#A-226

Truman Capote strongly disliked the adaptation, claiming Paramount had "double-crossed" him to appease 1960s audiences.

Edwards/Axelrod's 1961 Film

- Protagonist: Paul Varjak, a straight romantic interest.
- Tone: A sugar-and-spice Hollywood romantic comedy.
- Fate: Reunited in the rain.

FILM STRIP
REF: #A-224

Casting the Dream

Director Path

John
Frankenheimer
(attached for 3
months)

Replaced by
Blake Edwards at
the request of
Hepburn's agent.

Holly Path

Marilyn Monroe
(Capote's first
choice; declined
after Lee
Strasberg warned
it would hurt her
image)

Shirley MacLaine
/ Kim Novak
(declined)

Audrey Hepburn
(hesitant, fearing
she lacked the
extroversion for
the role).

Paul Path

Steve McQueen
(unavailable)

Jack Lemmon
(unavailable)

George Peppard.

Two Grifters in New York



Paul is a gigolo “kept” by a wealthy married woman, 2E Failenson.

Income Strategy



Holly survives on \$50 “powder room” tips and \$100 weekly drops for passing coded messages to the Sing Sing mafia.

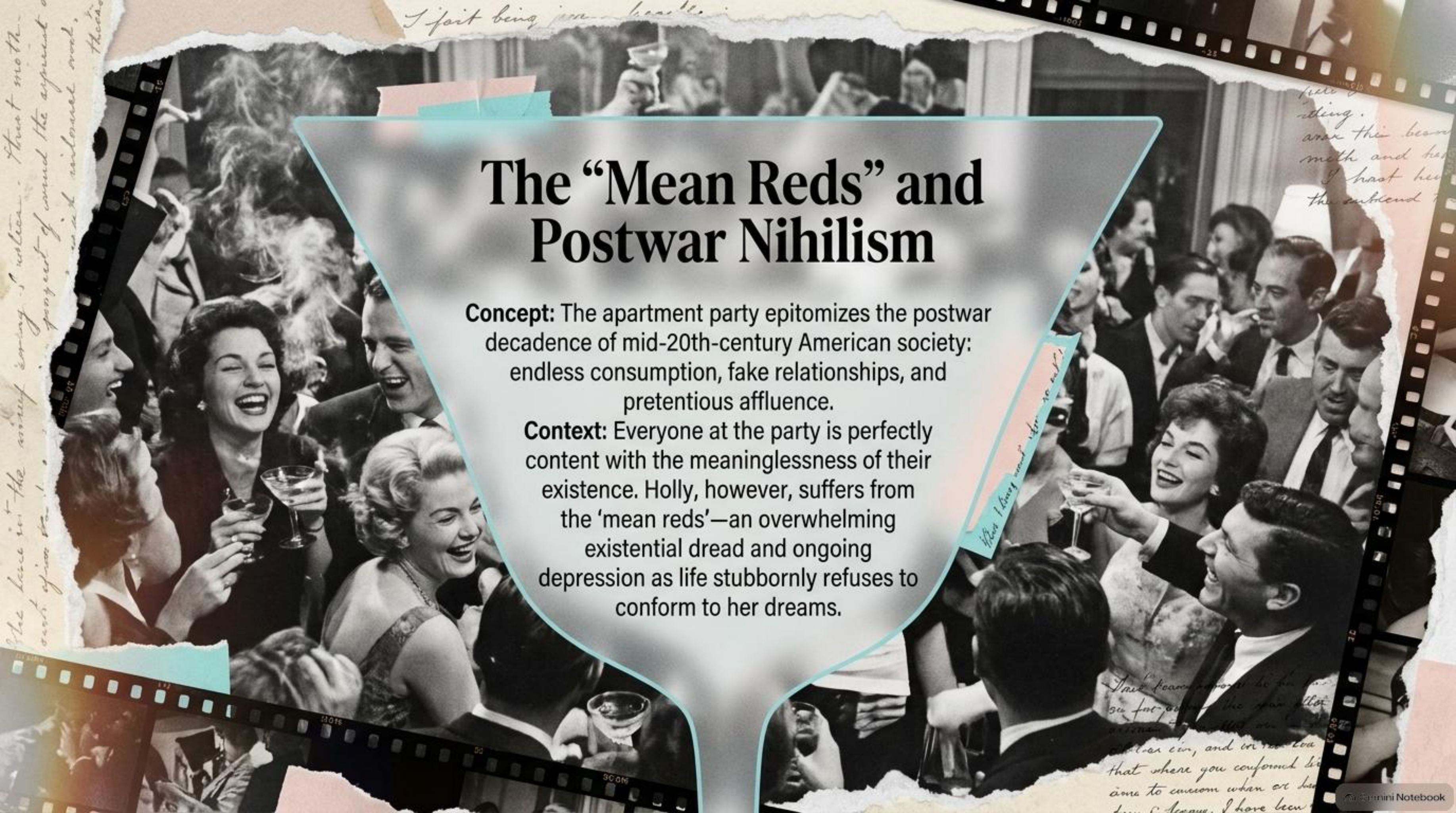
Paul acts as a “writer” despite not publishing in 5 years.

The Façade

Holly acts as a “socialite,” hiding her past as Lula Mae Barnes, a rural Texas girl married at 14.

The Trap

Both are willing to sell their bodies in a bid to save their souls, using fake sophistication to hide from the realities of failure and poverty.



The “Mean Reds” and Postwar Nihilism

Concept: The apartment party epitomizes the postwar decadence of mid-20th-century American society: endless consumption, fake relationships, and pretentious affluence.

Context: Everyone at the party is perfectly content with the meaninglessness of their existence. Holly, however, suffers from the ‘mean reds’—an overwhelming existential dread and ongoing depression as life stubbornly refuses to conform to her dreams.

A Flaw in the Diamond

Context: Mickey Rooney's casting as I.Y. Yunioshi remains an inexcusable blemish on the film's legacy.

The Impact: Driven by director Blake Edwards' pursuit of slapstick comedy, the performance resulted in a deeply offensive 'yellowface' stereotype.

The Legacy: Producer Richard Shepherd later expressed deep regret for the casting. The character stands today as a vital reminder of the antiquated prejudices that mar classic Hollywood cinema.



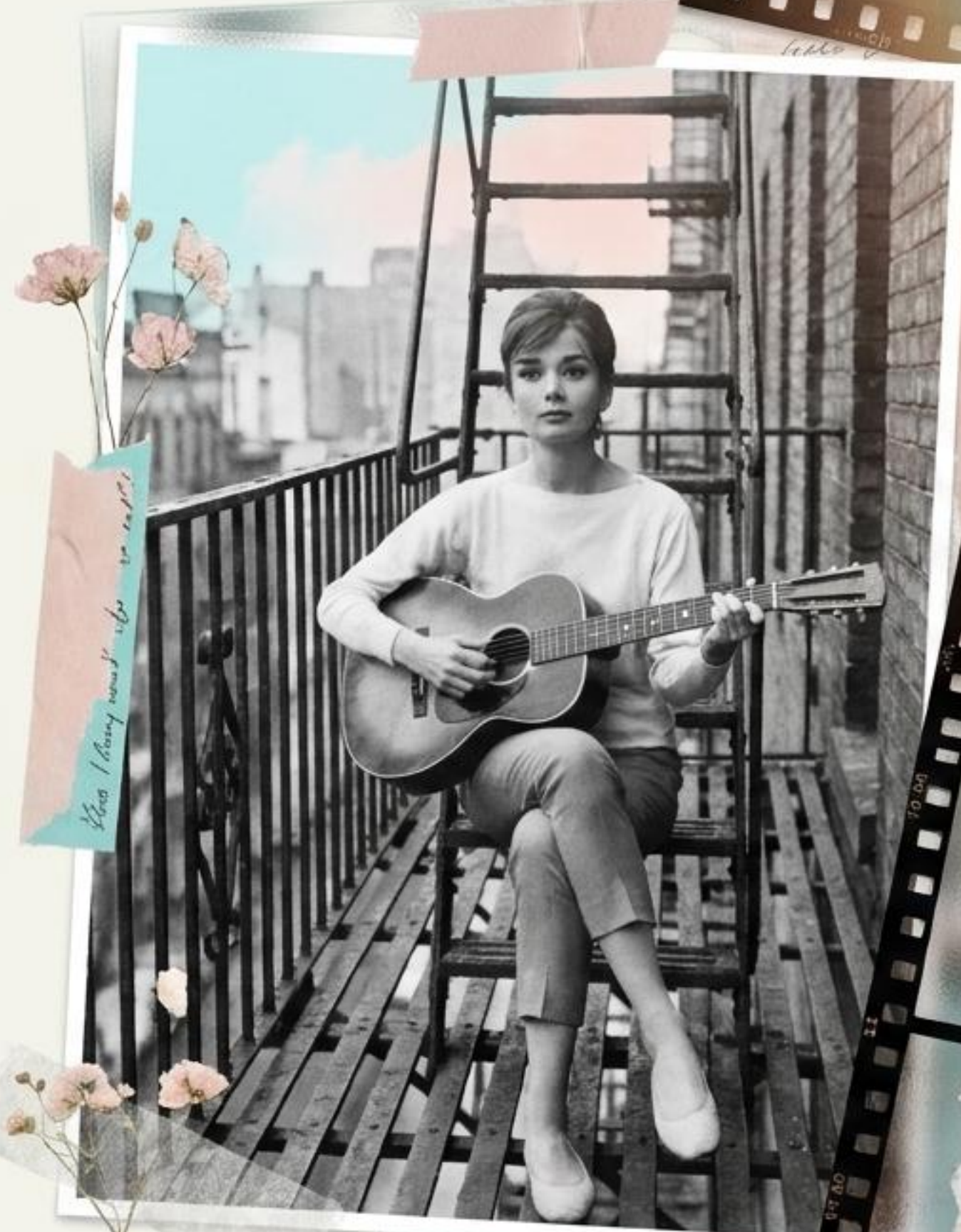
Anatomy of a Melody

🎵 **The Creators:**
Composed by Henry Mancini with lyrics by Johnny Mercer.

🎵 **The Meaning:** Mercer's lyrics reflect his **Savannah** youth picking huckleberries—the ultimate love song to wanderlust and a carefree childhood.

🎵 **The Voice:** Tailored specifically for Hepburn's limited, delicate vocal range.

🎵 **The Ultimatum:** When Paramount executive Martin Rackin ordered the song cut after a preview, Hepburn furiously replied, "Over my dead body!" It remained, winning two Grammys and an Oscar.





Costume jewelry, Rusty
Trawler's wealth, the
manufactured name
"Holly Golightly."

The Cracker Jack Ring. A cheap toy imbued with genuine value via an authentic Tiffany's engraving—the perfect blend of the fake and the real.

The nameless Cat and the
pouring rain.

The same best thing. I have a method some that
in one a night, built on the day, morning, noon
couple, I have loose light & breeze and at
the same thing hard to take. However, being
me in instant, I'm knowing what.

The Judge on the Shelf

Concept: Holly refuses to name her pet because she fears attachment, insisting "People don't belong to people."

Philosophy: The nameless Cat is the most authentic creature in the film. Looking down from high above the chaotic party-goers, Cat acts as a philosophical judge, silently staring down at the shallowness of human activity below.



*How much time on. Then just
my heart to be free - what then
understand that effort to do, I
know what will. The future we may
share belong now. How long and
sure to me. Now.*

A Ten-Dollar Day on the Town



The Pivot:

The moment Paul and Holly agree to do things they've never done before, dropping their respective facades.

The Actions:

They visit the library to see Paul's book, steal cheap dime-store masks, and spend exactly \$10 to engrave a Cracker Jack ring at Tiffany's.

The Result:

By stepping outside their transactional economy of gigolos and escorts, true connection finally begins to blossom.

The Philosophy of the Rain

The Breaking Point: After José abandons her, Holly tries to maintain her illusion of ultimate freedom by throwing Cat into the rainy alley.

The Rebuke: Paul shatters her facade: "You call yourself a free spirit, a 'wild thing', and you're terrified somebody's gonna stick you in a cage."

The Baptism: The rain acts as a natural baptism, washing away the postwar decadence, the costumes, and the lies, leaving only raw, unavoidable reality.



A Fairy Tale Rescued

Glamour & Escapism

(The Givenchy gloss, the Tiffany window)



The Enduring Masterpiece

Existential Dread

(The “mean reds,” postwar nihilism)

Authentic Love

(The Cracker Jack ring, the nameless Cat)

Takeaway: The film transcends its genre by suggesting that even within an artificial, materialistic society, individuals can still carve out a cocoon of real meaning and connection.



When my nome in the bend,
reunited with us having to all
of ma
me ha
me fa
e tou
and my
trum
mirced
thing.

It love
ting no
ther f
aka m
ted spo
e m
one

Waiting 'Round the Bend

"We're after the same rainbow's end, waiting, round the bend...
my Huckleberry Friend, Moon River, and me."

A lasting testament to the fairy tale of New York, where dreams,
loneliness, and hope finally meet at the Tiffany window.